

Frontal
bone

Flat bones

Thin, flattened, and usually curved, flat bones protect the body's most important organs. For example, the skull's temporal, frontal, and other flat bones surround the brain. Other flat bones include the ribs, shoulder blades, breastbone, and hip bones.

Irregular bones

These bones have complicated shapes. They include the 26 vertebrae that are stacked up to form the backbone or spine. In addition to supporting the upper body and allowing it to bend, the backbone also protects the spinal cord.

Backbone

Vertebra

Spinal
cord

SESAMOID BONES

These bones are shaped like sesame seeds. The patella (kneecap), which is a sesamoid bone, is found inside the tendon that attaches the thigh muscle to the shinbone. It increases the muscle's pulling power and protects the knee joint.



Patella

